

Name(s) _____ Period _____ Date _____

Project Guide - Paper Prototype



Overview

For this project you will be creating a paper prototype of an app to help a user address a need or interest. You have already chosen a user and identified a barrier or opportunity you would like to address. You will be prototyping an app that helps them overcome this barrier or that expands on this opportunity. Feel free to try creative new approaches to the problem you've identified, but whatever you decide to design, make sure you are empathizing with the needs of your user.

You will submit:

- This project guide
- The screens of your app. These will be drawn on notecards. At most you can have 6 screens
- A navigation diagram of your app, showing how your user moves between screens
- A poster showing off your prototype and describing how it works

Define

You have already recorded this information on the User Interview Activity Guide. Record those results below.

What is the need or interest you are focusing on?

What barrier or opportunity will your app address?

Prepare

As a class you should have discussed types of apps that can address your user's needs. Now it's time to start thinking about what specifically this app will do.

Briefly describe the type of app you are planning to design:

In the space below list the minimum features your app will need to meet your user's needs.

Try

Create Your Navigation Diagram

On the next page, sketch out the outline of your screens and how a user will navigate between them. Any information about how the user interacts with the app should be included on this diagram. To keep your app simple you should limit yourself to 6 screens at most. Some things to keep in mind:

- Focus on structure. What's the purpose of each screen? What features do they need to include?
- Start with core features. Only add "extras" once you're sure they're necessary
- Decide what consistent design features you'll use (e.g. a menu that's always at the top)
- Don't worry about drawing things perfectly. This is a sketch to help you design your final draft.

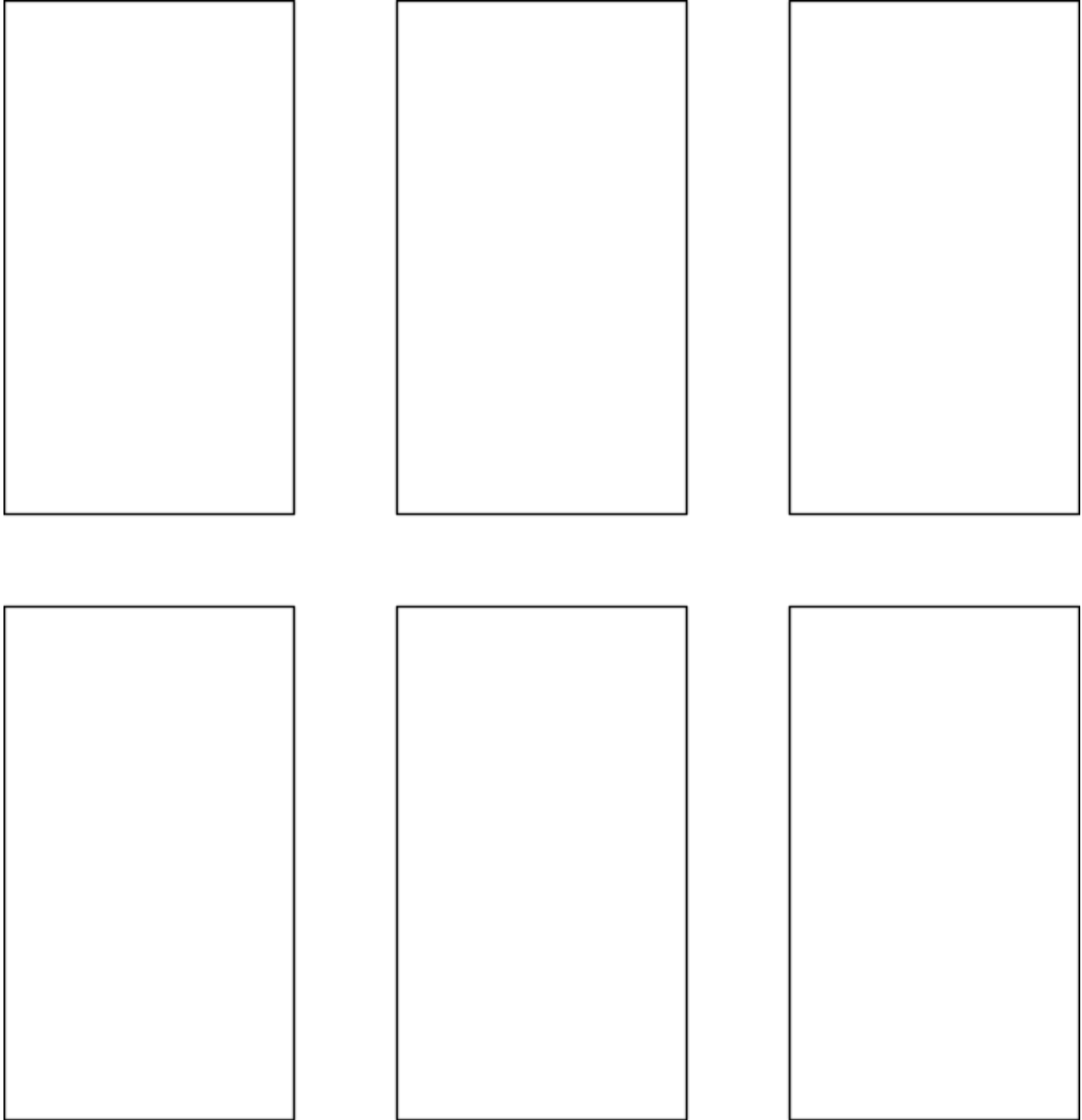
Create Your Screens

After you've created your navigation diagram, you will be given notecards to draw the final version of your screens. Using pencils, markers, colored pencils, or anything else you wish, create a paper prototype of your app. This should be more formal and look closely like how you imagine the finished app.

Navigation Diagram

Draw simple sketches of your screens in the space below. Then draw arrows showing how a user would navigate between your screens.

Any information about how the user interacts with the app needs to be included on this page.

The image contains six empty rectangular boxes, each representing a screen in an app. They are arranged in two rows of three. The top row has three boxes, and the bottom row has three boxes. These boxes are intended for drawing simple sketches of the app's screens.

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User Testing

Test Cases

Create User Tasks

Fill in the left column of the table with different common tasks your user will want to do with your app.

Test Your Prototype

Give this testing guide to your user. Test the app by starting them on the home screen and allowing them to navigate through it by clicking. Try to complete each task listed in the table. Here's some guidelines

- As the “computer” only use pieces of interaction included on the Navigation Diagram to move around the app
- Don't explain how the app works to your user. You want to observe how they would use it without guidance.
- The user can and should think out loud. This is a way to help you understand their experience
- Keep a scratch piece of paper to record anything else you notice during the test

Record Findings

In the “What I Tried” and “My Reaction” columns include what your user did to complete each task. In the next column include their reactions about how easy or approachable the app was to use.

Task	What I Tried	My Reaction

Reflect

Interpreting User Feedback

Using your notes from user testing, list all of your observations of interesting things the user said or did, and attempt to identify what that might mean about how your app works, or should work.

User Said / Did	What it Means

Create a Poster

Combine the different pieces of work you completed for this project to create a single poster. This will require you to cut out different parts of this activity guide and attach them to a single poster. Your poster should include:

- The name of your App
- Your navigational diagram (page 3)
- Your final user screens (index cards)
- Your table from the results of User Testing (this page)

In addition to the artifacts above, your poster must also have a section with 4-5 sentences that include:

- Describe the user that your app is targeted towards
- Describe the need or interest your app is addressing
- Describe your app and how it works
- Describe how your app addresses the needs of your user
- Describe any improvements you would make based on your testing